

Independence Day - Martina McBride

Martina McBride, *The Way That I Am*, 1994. Uptempo 90s country, ~120 BPM.

This isn't a flag-waving anthem despite the title -- it's a heavy, serious story song that hits hard on the choruses.

The bass needs to carry real weight and drive, not just sit under the fiddle.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

IR: Hartke410

Hartke XL410 (Slot 6) -- aluminum cones, bright and aggressive. Paired with the Classic Bass AMP model (Ampeg SVT).

No direct AMP match for this cab in the catalog, but the bright top end works well against a driving country-rock strum -- keeps the bass present instead of getting buried by acoustic and electric guitars.

- CAB: User IR 6, VOL 65.

- AMP: Classic Bass -- Gain 45, Bass 62, Middle 55, MidFreq 800Hz, Treble 58, VOL 70. Moderate gain, no breakup -- this is a clean, driving tone, not a dirty one. MidFreq at 800Hz keeps some bite for pick/finger attack to cut through the mix.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 35. Keeps the low end tight between phrases at this drive level.

PRE -- Micro Boost, on CTL.

Gain: 55 when engaged.

Off for the verse, on for the chorus -- same amp tone throughout, just pushed harder and louder for the hook, matching the song's serious, driving lift into each chorus.

DST -- off.

No drive/distortion anywhere on this one -- the weight comes from gain staging and low end, not grit. Distortion would fight the song's clean, driving country-rock character.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. See settings above.

CAB -- User IR 6 (Hartke410), always on. See settings above.

EQ -- off. The Hartke's inherent brightness plus the AMP's own tone controls cover what's needed -- no extra EQ stage.

MOD -- off. No modulation -- straight, driving part.

DLY -- off. No delay -- this is a direct, in-your-face bass part, not an ambient one.

RVB -- Room, on CTL.

Mix: 22, Decay: 40, Trail: false.

Off for the verse -- dry and direct. On for the chorus, alongside the boost -- adds a touch of size to match the bigger chorus arrangement without washing out the low end.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: PRE (Micro Boost) and RVB (Room).

- **CTL off** -- verse sound. Driving but restrained, dry and tight.
- **CTL on** -- chorus sound. Boosted and slightly roomier, more weight and push behind the hook.

Engage CTL going into each chorus, back off for the verses. Two-state song patch, matches the song's clear verse/chorus dynamic.